

Some states prohibit landlords from charging extra deposits for kids or pets or charging for credit checks. This doesn't mean your landlord won't try to charge you.

Utility Deposits and Hookup Charges

You may be required to pay a refundable deposit and nonrefundable hookup charges to one or more utility companies, including electric, gas, water, sewer, and cable TV. Many electric companies require a deposit of several hundred dollars. If you can prove you had electric service recently in your name in another location and you had a good payment record, the utility company may waive this requirement. To prevent paying for utilities used by the previous tenant, if possible take utility readings as soon as you move in. (Ask your landlord how you can do this.) When you move out, be sure to request your deposit back from the utility company.